

Problem Statement 1: Sustainable Decision Engine

Overview

Every day, people make dozens of small decisions how to travel, what to eat, what to buy. Individually, these choices seem insignificant. But collectively, they have a massive impact on the environment.

Consider a typical day:

- It's 8:30 AM. Riya is running late and books a cab despite surge pricing
- On the way, she orders a quick meal without considering alternatives
- In the evening, she shops online for essentials with fast delivery and extra packaging

At no point does she ask:

- Was there a more sustainable option?
- What was the environmental impact of her choices?

Not because she doesn't care—

but because she lacks the right information at the right moment.

Core Challenges

The problem is not intent it's lack of awareness and real time guidance:

- Sustainability data is not available at decision time
- Trade-offs between convenience, cost, and impact are unclear
- Existing solutions are passive, generic, or hard to act on
- Users are not nudged toward better choices in real world scenarios

As a result, decisions are driven by speed and convenience, not informed awareness.

The Challenge

Design a system that helps users make smarter, more sustainable decisions in real time.

Your solution should:

- Provide context-aware insights at the moment of decision-making
- Help users understand the impact of their choices
- Balance convenience vs sustainability, rather than forcing trade-offs

- Deliver actionable alternatives, not just information
 - Enable subtle nudges and behavior change without friction
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Technical Considerations

Focus on building decision intelligence, not just dashboards.

Key questions to think about:

- How will you provide real time recommendations?
- How do you quantify and present environmental impact in a simple way?
- How will you balance user convenience vs sustainability?
- What data sources will you use for accurate insights?
- How do you design low friction user experiences that influence behavior?